

1 Peter: Living as Exiles With Hope

How to belong to God in a world that no longer feels like home.

Text. 1 Peter 1 to 5

Good for. Believers who feel like strangers in their own culture

The arc. Peter writes to scattered Christians who are losing ground in their society and tells them they are not losing at all. The thread is a living hope that reframes suffering as the normal shape of following a crucified and risen Lord.

1. Born Again to a Living Hope

1 Peter 1:1-12

Big idea. An imperishable inheritance is kept in heaven for exiles whose trials refine a faith more precious than gold.

Aim. To anchor the hearer's hope in something no loss on earth can touch.

Notes

2. Be Holy, for He Is Holy

1 Peter 1:13 to 2:3

Big idea. Those ransomed by the blood of Christ live set apart, loving one another from a heart born again by the living word.

Aim. To connect the hearer's daily holiness to the price that was paid for them.

Notes

3. Living Stones, Chosen People

1 Peter 2:4-12

Big idea. Rejected by the world, believers are built into a temple and a people whose conduct preaches to the watching nations.

Aim. To give the hearer an identity larger than the rejection they feel.

Notes

4. Submission and the Suffering Servant

1 Peter 2:13 to 3:7

Big idea. In every station, believers follow the steps of the Christ who suffered without retaliation and entrusted Himself to God.

Aim. To shape the hearer's relationships by the pattern of the cross.

Notes

5. Suffering for Doing Good

1 Peter 3:8-22

Big idea. Blessing those who revile us and being ready to answer for our hope, we follow the Christ who suffered the righteous for the unrighteous.

Aim. To prepare the hearer to meet hostility with hope instead of fear.

Notes

6. Done With Sin, Alive to God

1 Peter 4:1-11

Big idea. The time for the old life is over, and the end of all things calls believers to sober prayer and earnest love.

Aim. To break the hearer's nostalgia for the life Christ already pulled them out of.

Notes

7. Rejoice in the Fiery Trial

1 Peter 4:12-19

Big idea. Suffering as a Christian is not strange but a sharing in Christ's sufferings, entrusted to a faithful Creator.

Aim. To remove the hearer's surprise at suffering and replace it with trust.

Notes

8. Shepherds, Humility, and the God of All Grace

1 Peter 5:1-14

Big idea. Elders shepherd willingly, the young submit humbly, and the whole church casts its anxiety on the God who will restore them.

Aim. To send the hearer out humbled, watchful, and held by grace.

Notes

HOW TO USE THIS SERIES

These are starting points, not scripts. Each series gives you the arc, the divisions, and a working aim for every sermon, but the breakdown here is scaffolding you will take down once the text has done its own work in you. Read the whole book before you preach the first week of it. Let the passage divisions teach you where the seams actually are.

The text sets the agenda. Not the felt needs you arrived with, not the outline that looks clean on a slide, not the application you already know you want to land. Sit under the passage long enough for it to surprise you, and then preach what it says rather than what you planned. A big idea you did not have to fight for is usually one the text did not give you.